



MERLINE TOLENTINO-AQUINO, CPA

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SUMMARY OF QUALIFICATIONS

Currently, Head of Finance & Accounting in specialized retail sector, a Sr. Accounting Manager from Abu Dhabi, UAE, with 16 years of Accounting & Finance experience, plus 9 years in the local banking sector; possessing competencies in the following areas:

- ❑ Financial reporting and analysis; end-to-end (R2R) accounting, financial planning, budgeting & forecasting; cost control; cash management & treasury, financial modelling, internal audit
- ❑ Developing workflow processes aimed at strengthening internal controls to mitigate risks; as well as improving operational performance in line with lean six sigma approach
- ❑ ERP system: SAP B1, Oracle E-Business Suite; MS Office Suites: Excel, Word, Power point, Visio
- ❑ Leadership, analytical and mathematical skills, time management and organizational skills
- ❑ Communication and interpersonal skills aimed at developing professional and cross-functional connections & collaboration

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Philippine Vending Corporation, Pasig City (*largest vending operator and number one office convenience service provider in the Philippines*)

Employment Tenure: August 2022 to Present

Head of Finance & Accounting

- ❑ Responsible for managing, supervising, and directing financial activities of the company, with the goal of achieving the various financial KPI's
- ❑ Supervision of accounting, finance, treasury, AR & collection and internal audit sections
- ❑ Leads the accounting closing process, reviews GL balances to ensure financial statements accurately represent the financial health of the company
- ❑ Prepares financial statements with analysis and insights; tracks performance against budget; presents recommendations on resource allocation and expedient management decisions to drive business growth and profitability
- ❑ Manages cash flow by supervising the billing & collection, cash management and treasury sections of finance, to ensure appropriate & sufficient cash flow and the optimal use of banking facilities as needed
- ❑ Directs the internal audit section in conducting compliance, operational and financial audit based on evaluation of risk areas; recommend remedial/corrective actions and enhancements on company policies & procedures
- ❑ Leads the annual budget preparation process in line with strategic & operational goals, assists various departments using a combination of top-down and bottom-up approach
- ❑ Presides over the retail price review and monitoring committee consisting of heads of various departments, to ensure standard profit margin; decide on pricing strategies using price volume mix analysis
- ❑ Develops workflow processes with the goal of strengthening internal controls and improving operational performance in line with lean six sigma approach
- ❑ Part of the core leadership team that directs the ERP upgrade implementation, system integration and other digital transformation initiatives aimed at efficiency and cost savings through automation
- ❑ Coordinate external/statutory audit as well as BIR examination of books; ensure compliance with regulatory requirements

Accenture, Inc. Philippines (*a global professional services company that specialises in IT, Financial Accounting services and management consultancy*)

Employment Tenure: August 2021 to February 2022

Associate Accounting Manager

- ❑ Manage and supervises a team of 85 Accountants who executes general accounting processes,
- ❑ Management of core financial processes such as accounting, recording, amortization, monthly, quarterly & annual reporting
- ❑ Provide team support, resolution of complex issues, definition of standards and approaches as well as planning

- ☐ Responsible for improvement of accounting system, work flows and processes
- ☐ Monitoring of profitability of the project by keeping costs below the contract value, as per financial performance indicators.
- ☐ Management of internal/external client relationship
- ☐ Interview applicants for Accounting position and assessing their qualifications and fitness for the job requirement

Aldar Education LLC, Abu Dhabi, UAE *(a 100% subsidiary of Aldar Properties PJSC, it is the largest & leading educational management in Abu Dhabi)*

Employment Tenure: June 2014 to October 2020

Senior Accounting Manager

- ☐ Responsible for all sections of the centralized accounting department for all 8 schools, supervising the team's daily operations
- ☐ Ensures accurate and timely accounting, recordkeeping and management of financial accounting data in accordance with IFRS
- ☐ Reviews and approves payment to Suppliers, banking transactions, invoicing and revenue entries, GL entries, Payroll processing and other employee benefits payments
- ☐ Coordinates and reviews the consolidated monthly financial reports and department-wise reports in line with management requirements
- ☐ Manages the annual budgeting preparation process across the various departments and schools; build the consolidated company budget for approval by the board
- ☐ Performs budget monitoring thru cost-control procedures in coordination with Procurement team and Dept. Heads
- ☐ Monitors cash position, prepares quarterly cash flow forecast, coordinates all banking-related matters and concerns
- ☐ Develops processes and work flows aimed at improving efficiency and productivity, while strengthening internal control within the organization
- ☐ Designs financial reports that provide relevant information necessary in key decision-making by executive management
- ☐ Reviews and approves VAT transaction schedules, filing of returns as well as timely payment of tax liabilities
- ☐ Works closely with Human Resources to ensure compliance with payroll policies and procedures including regulatory controls

Ali & Sons Group of Companies, Abu Dhabi, UAE *(a diversified group with established presence in the automobile sector, commercial, oil & gas, retailing, contracting, manufacturing, IT and merchant banking)*

Employment tenure: June 2006 – June 2014

Ali & Sons Corporate Office – Management Reports Senior Accountant

- ☐ Reports directly to the Group CFO and coordinates with the Finance Managers of subsidiary companies
- ☐ Prepares the group's monthly consolidated financial statement and comprehensive management report
- ☐ Reviews and performs analysis on the financial report of each subsidiary company
- ☐ Provides advisory, assistance and guidance on the financial reporting issues of subsidiary companies
- ☐ Consolidates the group's annual budget and monitors compliance and achievement
- ☐ Coordinates with the external audit team on the performance of audit for the entire group
- ☐ Performs analysis of investment opportunities in various asset class (private equity, listed securities, fixed-income, derivatives, etc.)

Ali & Sons Marine Engineering Factory – Supervisor/Senior Accountant

- ☐ Supervises Accountants assigned to various areas of Accounting: AP, AR, Fixed Assets & Payroll
- ☐ Prepares the company's monthly financial statement and management report
- ☐ Reviews accounting entries, supplier payments, reconciliation of accounts and manual payroll
- ☐ Coordinates with Cost Controller as to revenue recognition based on Cost-to-Complete report
- ☐ In charge of the entire process, cycle of Letters of Credit (L/C's) for international trade, and processing of bank or financial guarantees issued by the company
- ☐ Monitors cash flow and prepares weekly cash management plan
- ☐ Reviews construction contracts to determine schedules of collection according to completion milestones
- ☐ Prepares annual budget in coordination with various departments
- ☐ Coordinates with external auditor in its conduct of audit engagement, in cooperation with the Accounting team

Injaz Mena Investment Co.PSC - Chief Accountant

- ☐ Responsible for the daily operation of the Accounting & Finance department, AP, AR and Payroll
- ☐ Prepares the monthly consolidated financial statements, and comprehensive management reports
- ☐ Monitors daily cash position, cash flow and budget compliance
- ☐ Analyzes private equity deals and securities trading as to accounting treatment in compliance with IFRS/IAS;
- ☐ Prepares schedule of periodic revaluation of investments classified as held for trading and available for sale;
- ☐ Prepares Central Bank monthly and quarterly reporting for submission via the CB Online Reporting System;
- ☐ Coordinates with external auditor during the conduct of audit
- ☐ Prepares quarterly Statement of Accounts for each client/investor, for investments held on a fiduciary basis;

Asia Trust Bank, Manila, Philippines (Sep 2005 – Apr 2006)

Assistant Manager/Accounts Officer

Banco De Oro Universal Bank, Manila, Philippines (December 2001 – February 2004)
Branch Operations Officer

Far East Bank and Trust Company, Manila, Philippines (July 1994 to April 2000)
Branch Operations Officer

EDUCATIONAL ATTAINMENT

Bachelor of Science in Commerce , Major in Accounting (1993)	University of Batangas	Batangas City, Philippines
Bachelor of Arts , Major in English (1993)	University of Batangas	Batangas City, Philippines

Passed the **CPA Licensure Examination** in Manila, Philippines in June, 1994

CHARACTER REFERENCE

Hon. Judge Gener Gito - Regional Trial Court Presiding Judge, Muntinlupa City

Mr. Shabraiz Hassan – Metcash, Australia

Dr. Noreen Molina – Makati City

(Contact details of the foregoing will be provided upon request)